

FEMA National Watch Center

Daily Operations Briefing

Tuesday, September 29, 2026

8:30 a.m. ET



FEMA

National Current Operations / Monitoring

New Significant Incidents / Ongoing Operations:

- Flooding – Southwest

Hazard Monitoring:

- Heavy Rain / Flash Flooding – Southwest to Middle Mississippi Valley
 - Atlantic:
 - Tropical Storm Fay
 - Tropical Storm Hanna
 - Eastern and Central Pacific:
 - Hurricane Nolo (CAT-3)
 - Hurricane Polo (CAT-1)
 - Tropical Storm Rachel
 - Disturbance 1: High (90%)
 - Western Pacific:
 - Invest 93W: Med

Disaster Declaration Activity:

- Request: Major Disaster Declaration – Pueblo of Zuni

Event Monitoring:

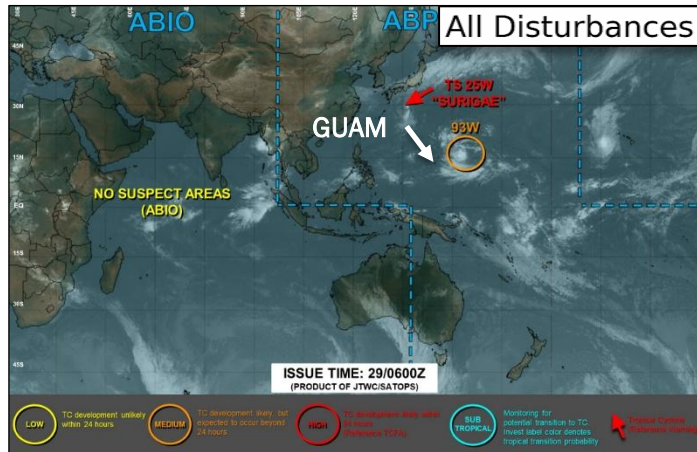
- No new significant events



FEMA

Tropical Outlook

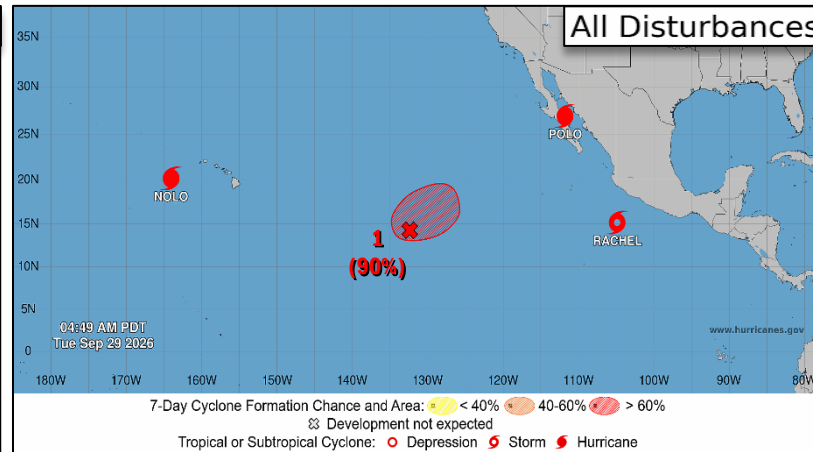
Western Pacific



Invest 93W: (as of 2:00 a.m. ET)

- Located 698 miles ENE of Guam
- Maximum sustained winds of 20-26 mph
- Environmental conditions reveal favorable conditions for development
- Formation chance – 24-hour: Med

Eastern and Central Pacific



Hurricane Nolo (CAT-3): (Advisory #35A, as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- See next slide

Hurricane Polo (CAT-1): (Advisory #35A, as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- See next slide

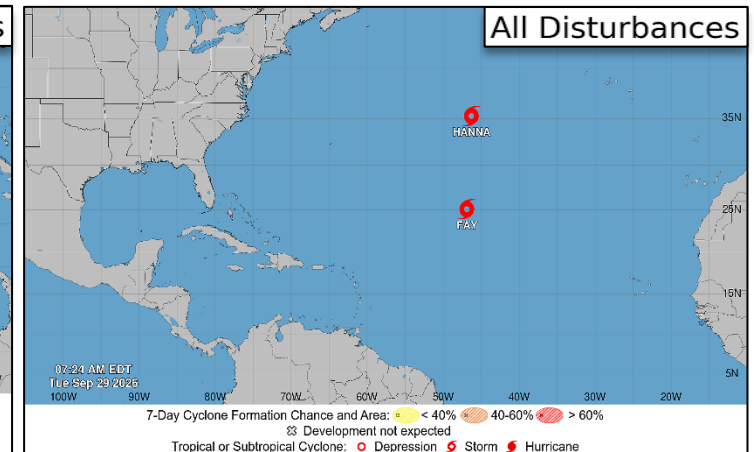
Tropical Storm Rachel: (Advisory #9A, as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- See next slide

Disturbance 1 (EP91): (as of 2:00 a.m. ET)

- Well ESE of the Hawaiian Islands
- The system is expected to become a tropical depression during the next day or two; environmental conditions are less conducive for development late this week
- Formation chance – 48-hour: High (90%); 7-day: High (90%)

Atlantic



Tropical Storm Fay: (Advisory #37, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- See next slide

Tropical Storm Hanna: (Advisory #4, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- See next slide



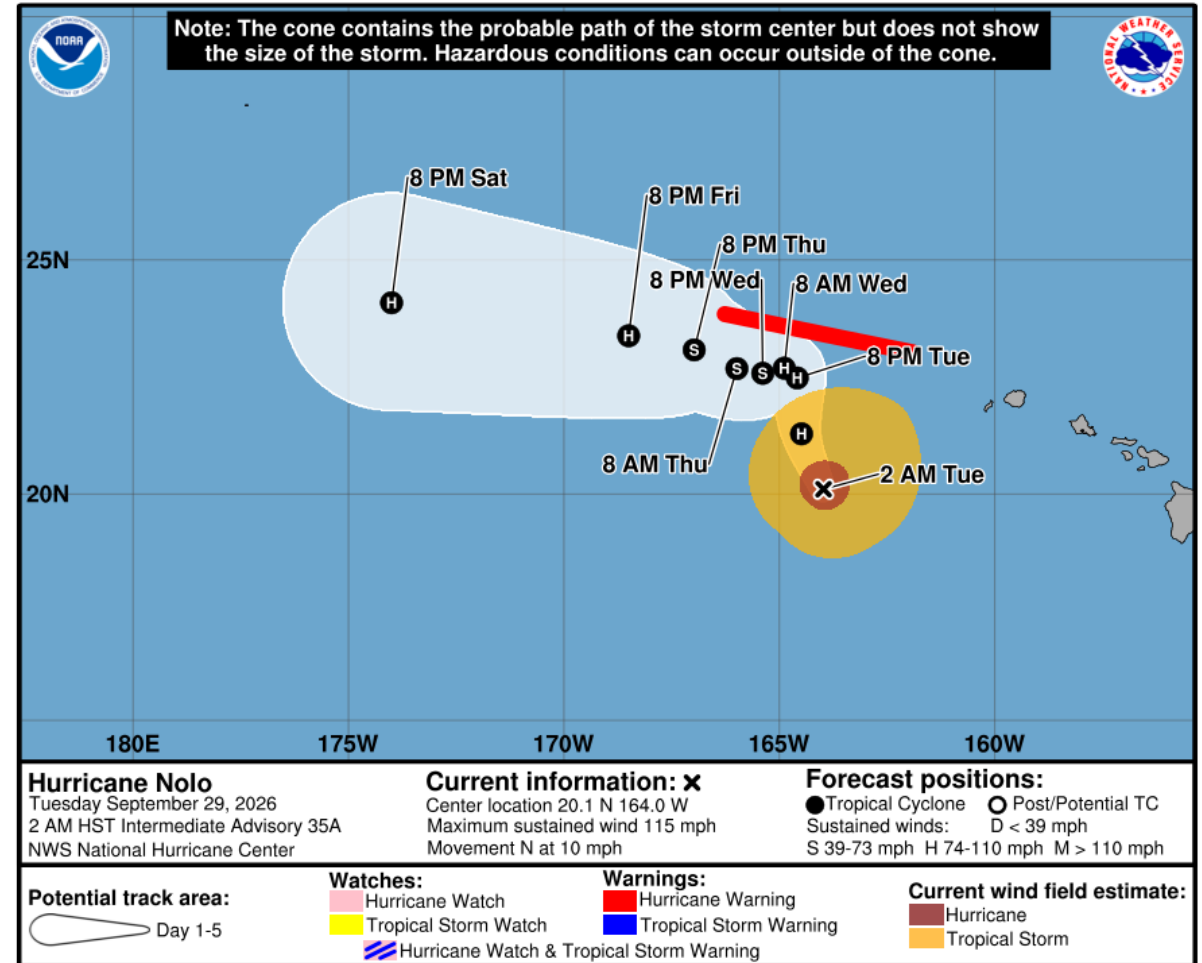
FEMA

National Watch Center

Hurricane Nolo (CAT-3) – Central Pacific

Situation: (Advisory #35A, as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Located 405 miles W of Honolulu, Hawaii
- Maximum sustained winds of 115 mph
- Moving N at 10 mph
- Hurricane-force winds extend up to 45 miles from center; tropical-storm-force winds extend up to 175 miles from center
- Weakening is forecast over the next couple of days, followed by some re-intensification during the latter parts of this week



FEMA

National Watch Center

Hurricane Polo (CAT-1) – Eastern Pacific

Situation: (Advisory #35A, as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Located 65 miles NNW of Loreto, Mexico
- Moving NE at 10 mph
- Maximum sustained winds of 75 mph
- Hurricane-force winds extend up to 30 miles from center; tropical storm-force winds extend up to 90 miles from center
- Rapid weakening is forecast later today when Polo moves well inland over mainland Mexico



FEMA

National Watch Center

Tropical Storm Rachel – Eastern Pacific

Situation: (Advisory #9A, as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Located 265 miles SW of Lazaro Cardenas, Mexico
- Moving WNW at 13 mph
- Maximum sustained winds 60 mph
- Tropical-storm-force winds extend outward up to 160 miles from the center
- Gradual strengthening is expected during the next few days, and Rachel is forecast to become a hurricane in the next day or so



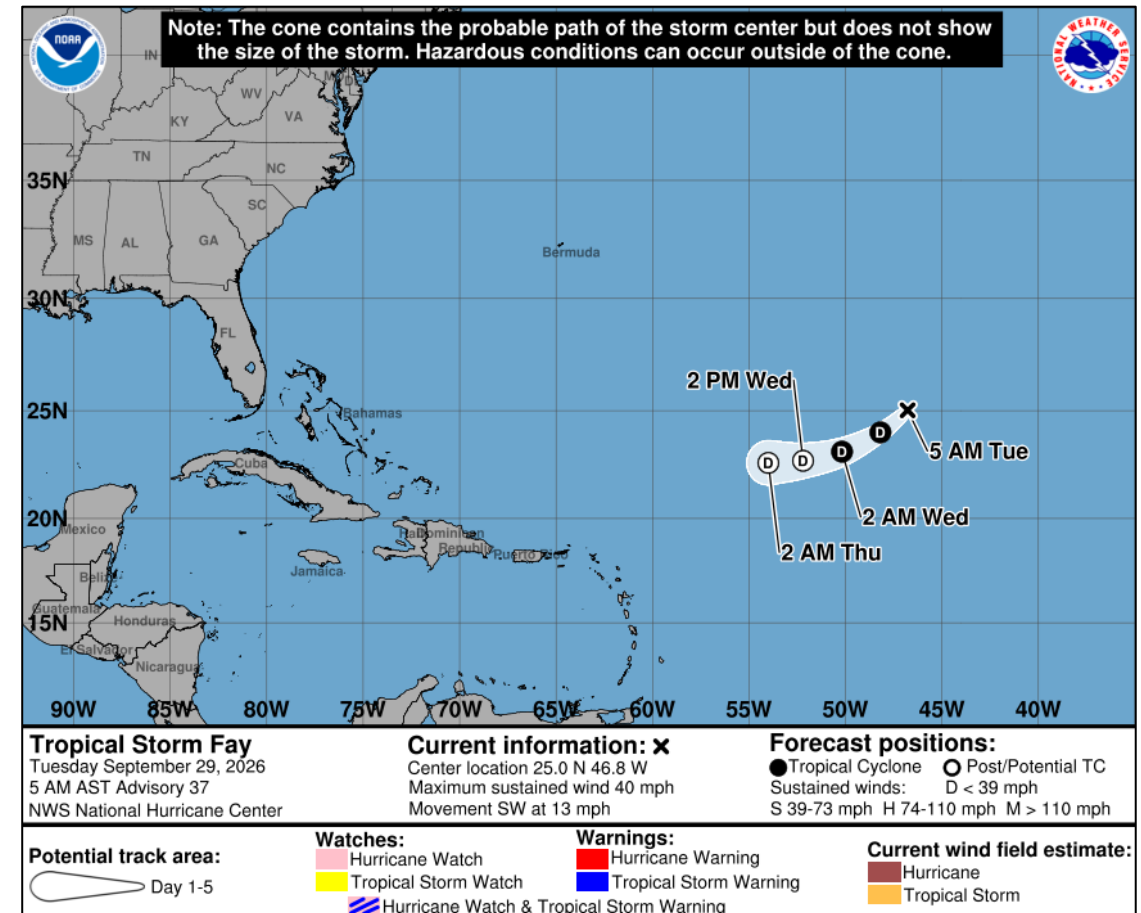
FEMA

National Watch Center

Tropical Storm Fay – Atlantic

Situation: (Advisory #37, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- Located 1,465 miles WSW of the Azores
- Moving SW at 13 mph
- Maximum sustained winds 40 mph
- Some weakening is expected during the next day or so, and Fay is forecast to become a post-tropical cyclone within 36 hours



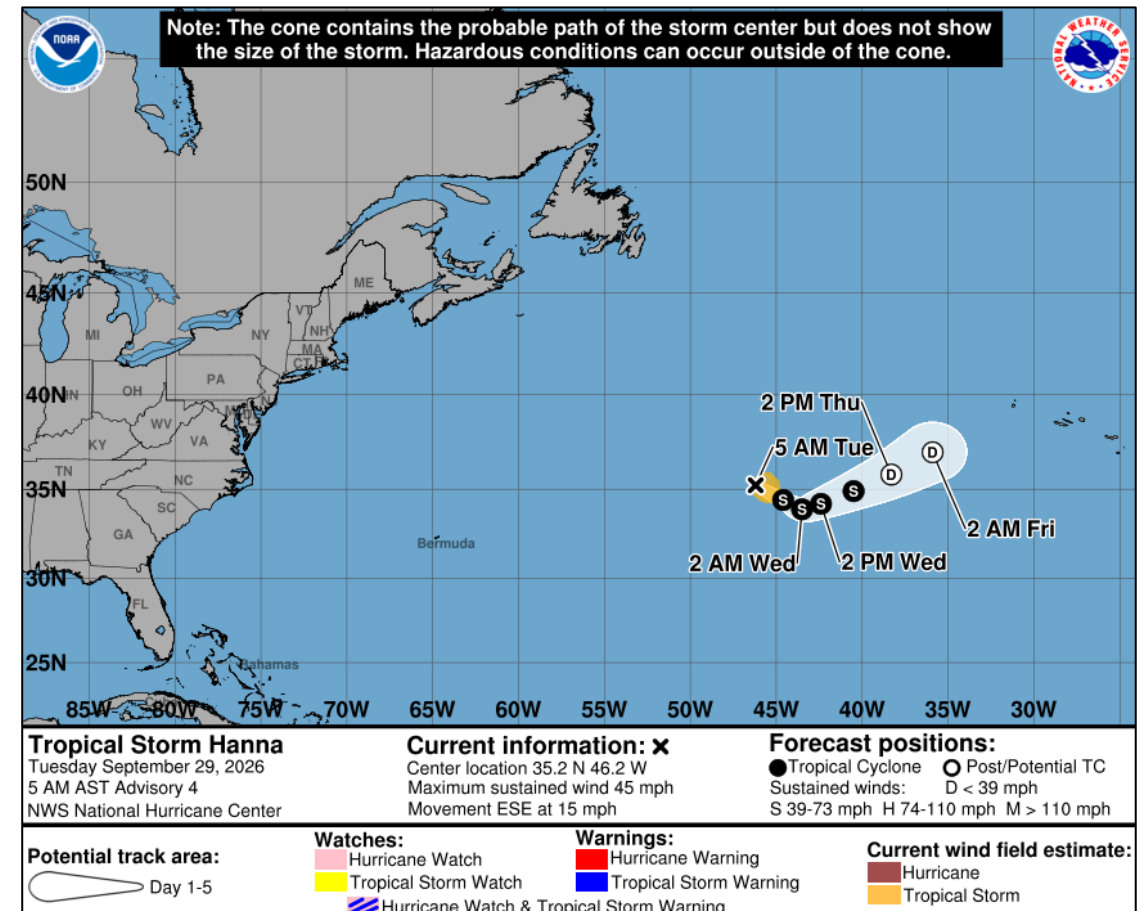
FEMA

National Watch Center

Tropical Storm Hanna – Atlantic

Situation: (Advisory #4, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- Located 1,085 mi miles ENE of Bermuda
- Maximum sustained winds of 45 mph
- Moving ESE at 15 mph
- Tropical-storm-force winds extend outward up to 90 miles from the center
- Hanna is likely to become a post-tropical cyclone by the latter part of this week

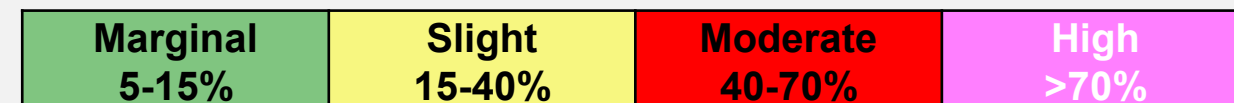
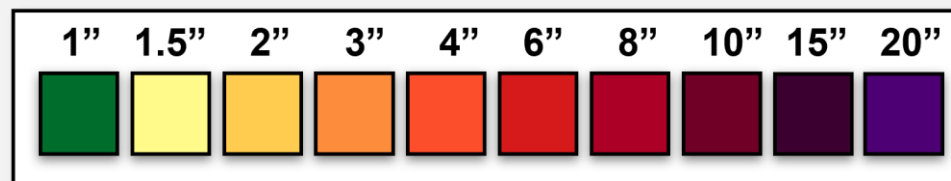
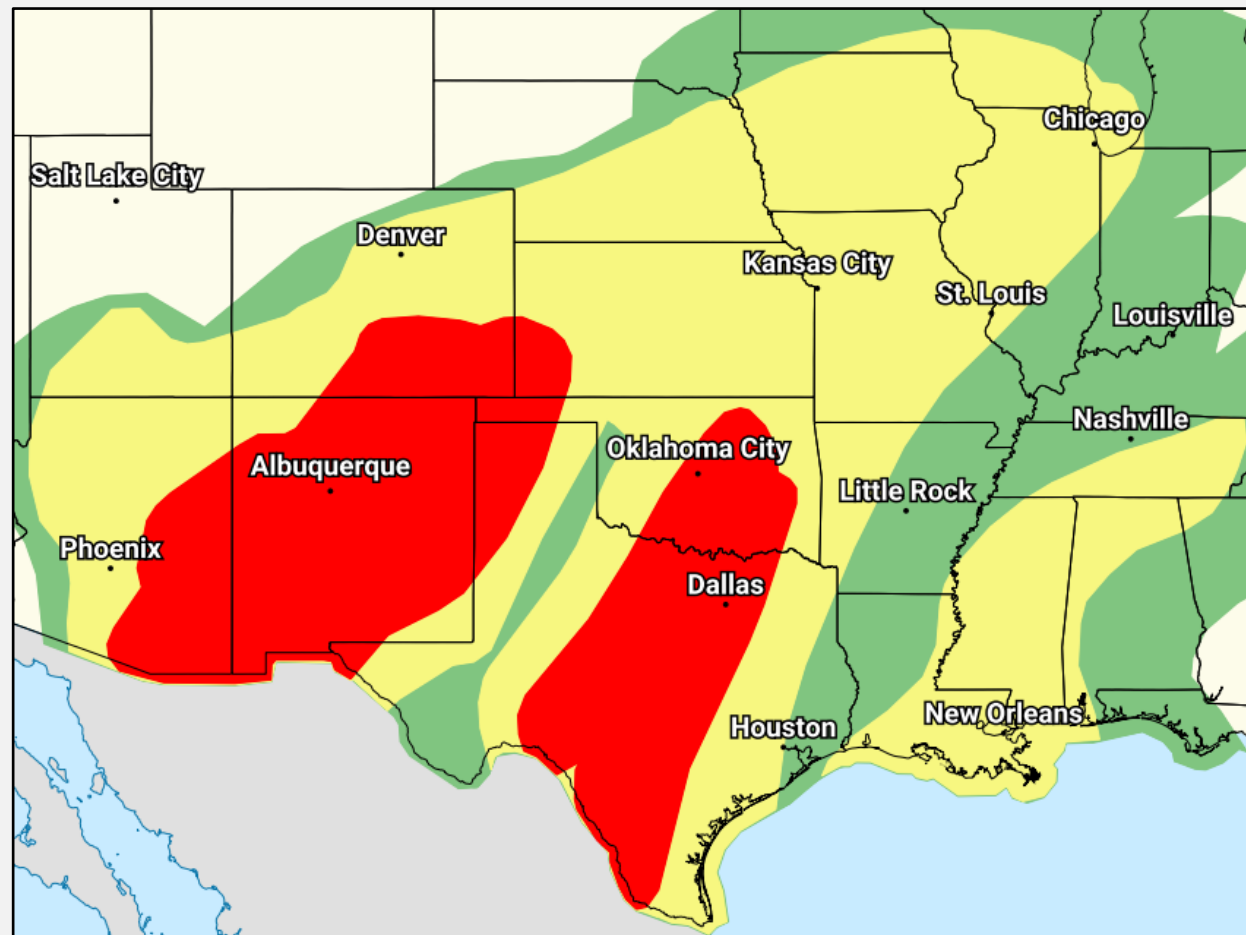
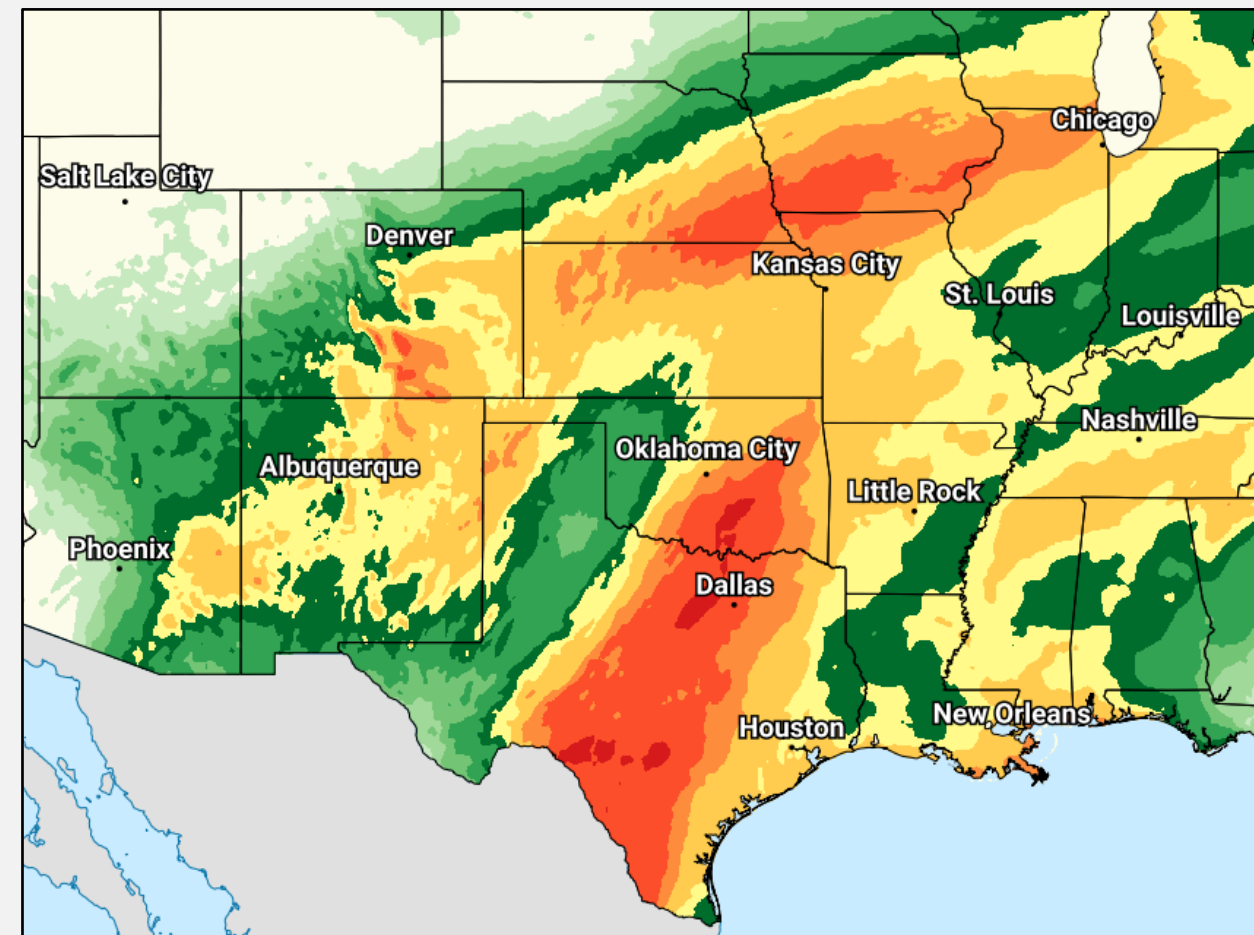


FEMA

National Watch Center

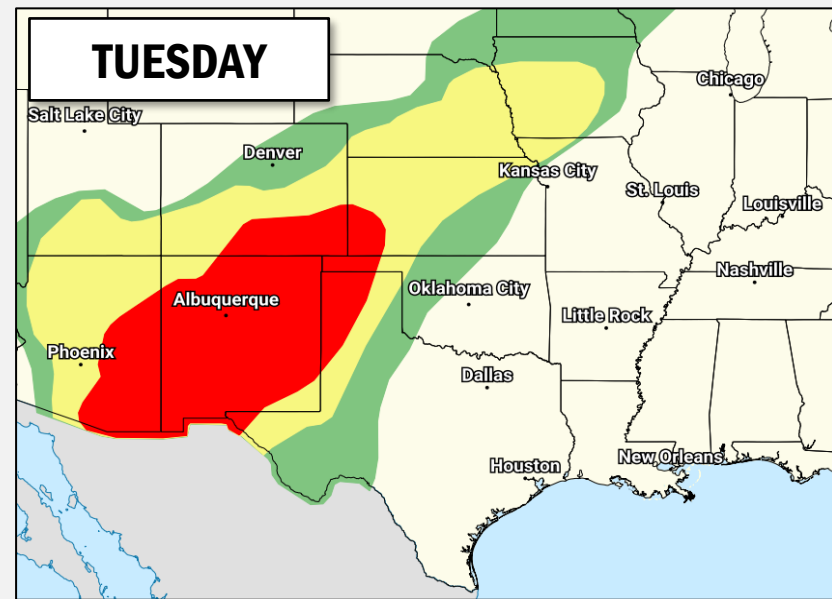


Rainfall Forecast & Flash Flooding Risk THROUGH SATURDAY NIGHT

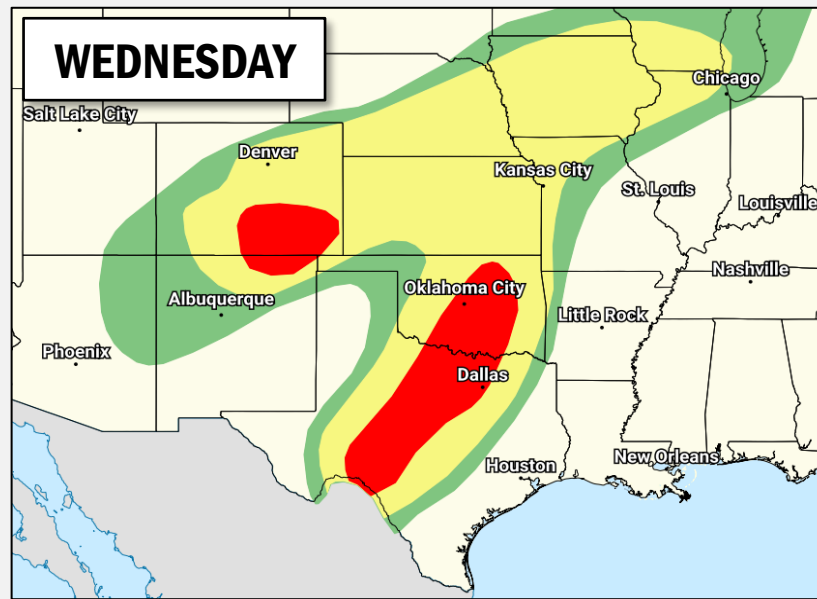


Flash Flooding Risk

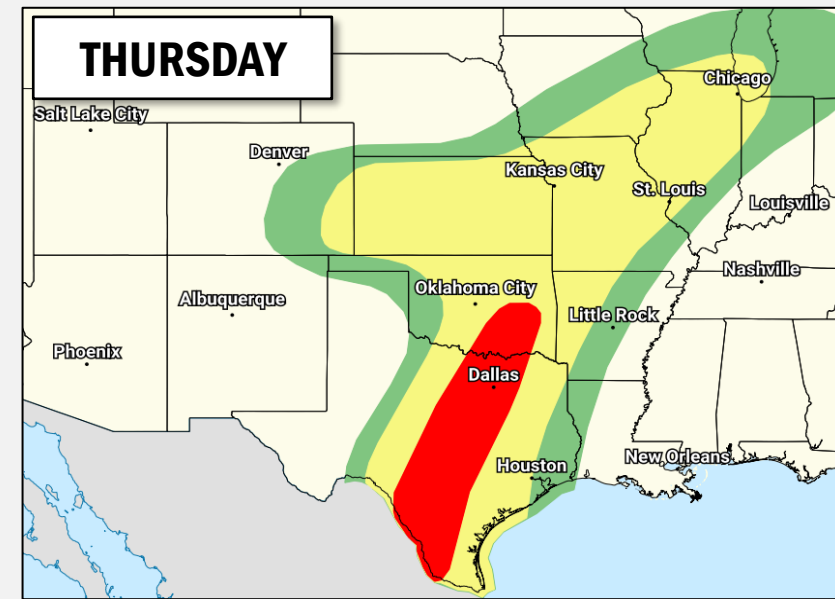
TUESDAY



WEDNESDAY



THURSDAY



Risk of Flash Flooding

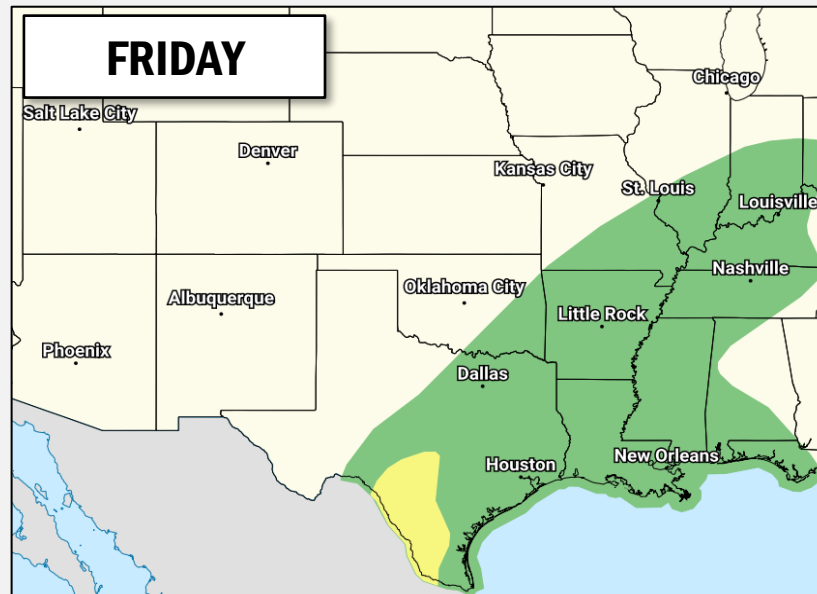
High

Moderate

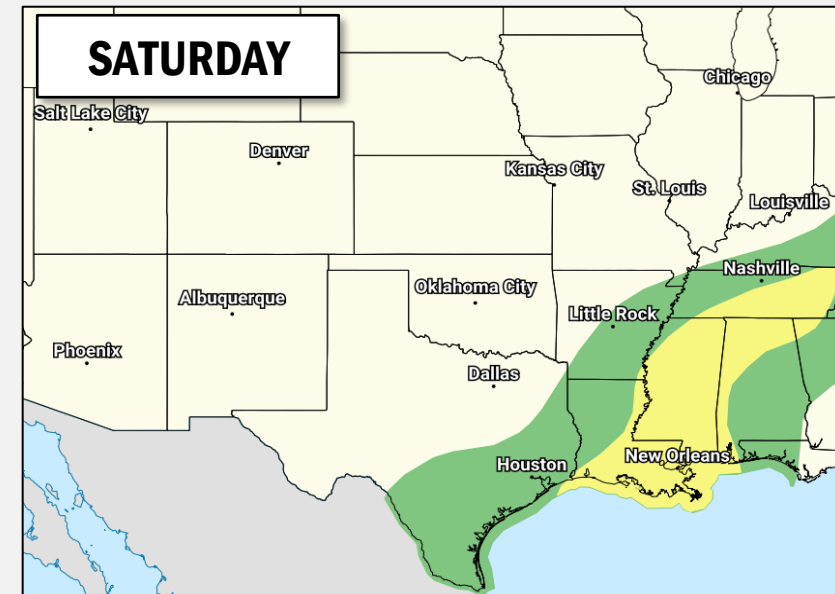
Slight

Marginal

FRIDAY



SATURDAY



Flooding – Southwest

NM



Situation: A wave of tropical moisture moving in from the Pacific brings a multi-day period of showers and thunderstorms with periods of heavy rainfall, and an increased potential for considerable flash flooding impacts. Tropical moisture brings a renewed significant flash flooding threat to New Mexico, west Texas, and the Texas Panhandle early this week. As the week progresses flash and urban flooding could become likely across parts of central Texas—including Texas Hill Country—and into Oklahoma. FEMA has deployed a Regional Incident Management Assistance Team (R-IMAT) as well as Urban Search and Rescue (US&R) assets in support of any emerging requirements. (SLB #1, as of 6:14 p.m. ET, Sep 28)

State / Local Response: (FEMA IAB #1, as of 12:00 p.m. ET, Sep 28; SLB #1, as of 6:14 p.m. ET, Sep 28)

- NM SEOC at Partial Activation (Excessive Rainfall)
- TX SEOC at Partial Activation (Severe Weather)

FEMA / Federal Response:

FEMA Region 6:

- Watch is Monitoring; RRCC is Activated with select ESFs
- R-IMAT 1 is Deployed to Santa Fe, NM (Flooding)
- LNO is Deployed to TX SEOC

FEMA Region 7:

- Watch is Monitoring; RRCC is Rostered
- R-IMAT is Available

FEMA Region 8:

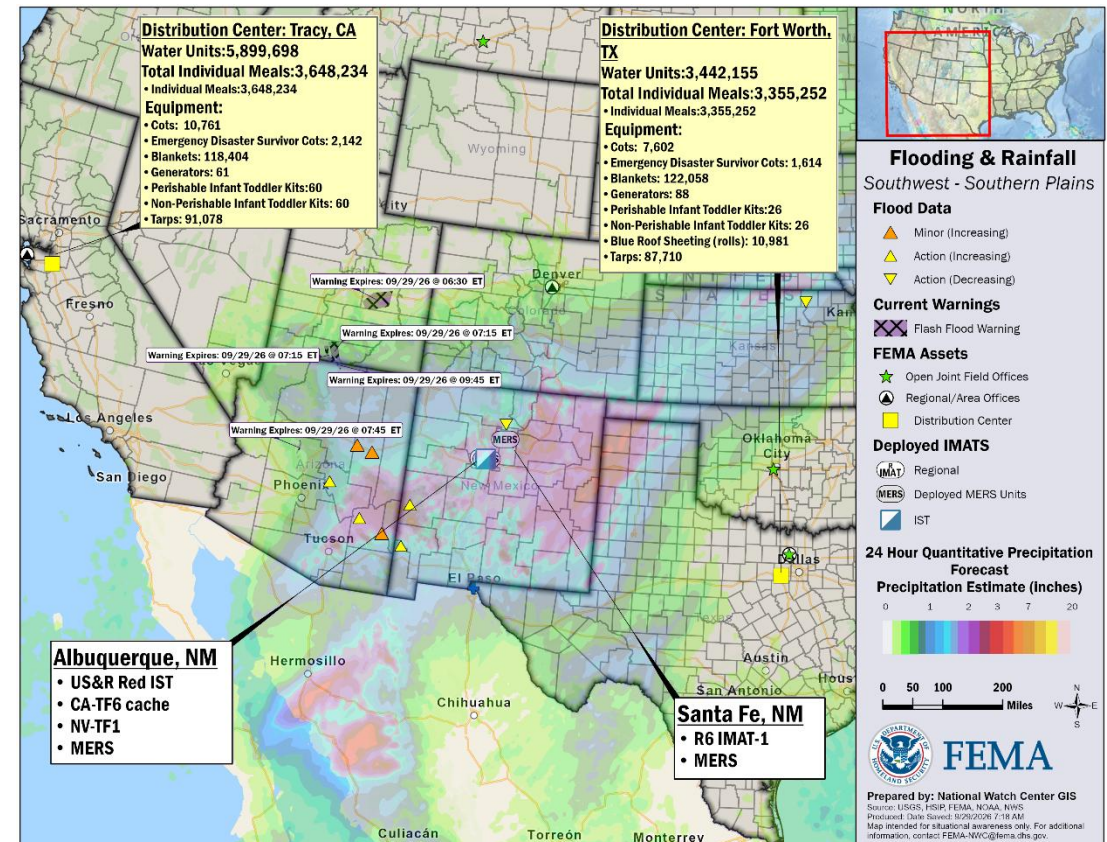
- Watch is Monitoring; RRCC is Rostered
- R-IMAT is Deployed to SD (FEMA-4941-DR-OST)

HQ:

- NWC is at Enhanced Watch (TC Nolo/Southwest Flooding, 8:00 a.m. ET to 5:00 p.m. ET)
- Response Operations held a coordination call Sep 28

US&R: NV-TF1 (Type 3), CA-TF6 IST Cache, and Red IST deployed to Albuquerque, NM

MERS: MERS assets deployed to Albuquerque and Santa Fe, NM



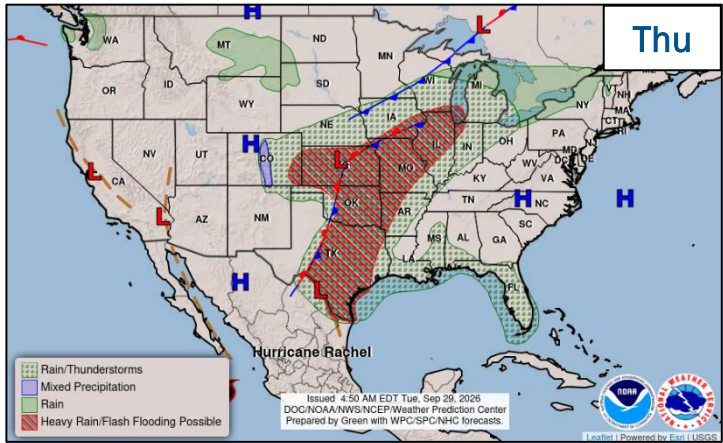
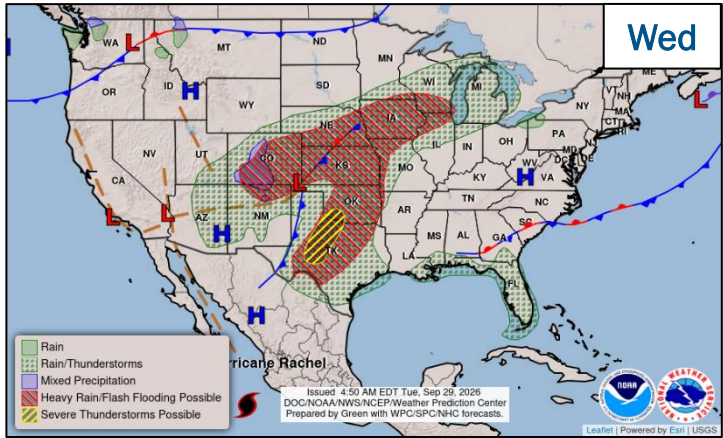
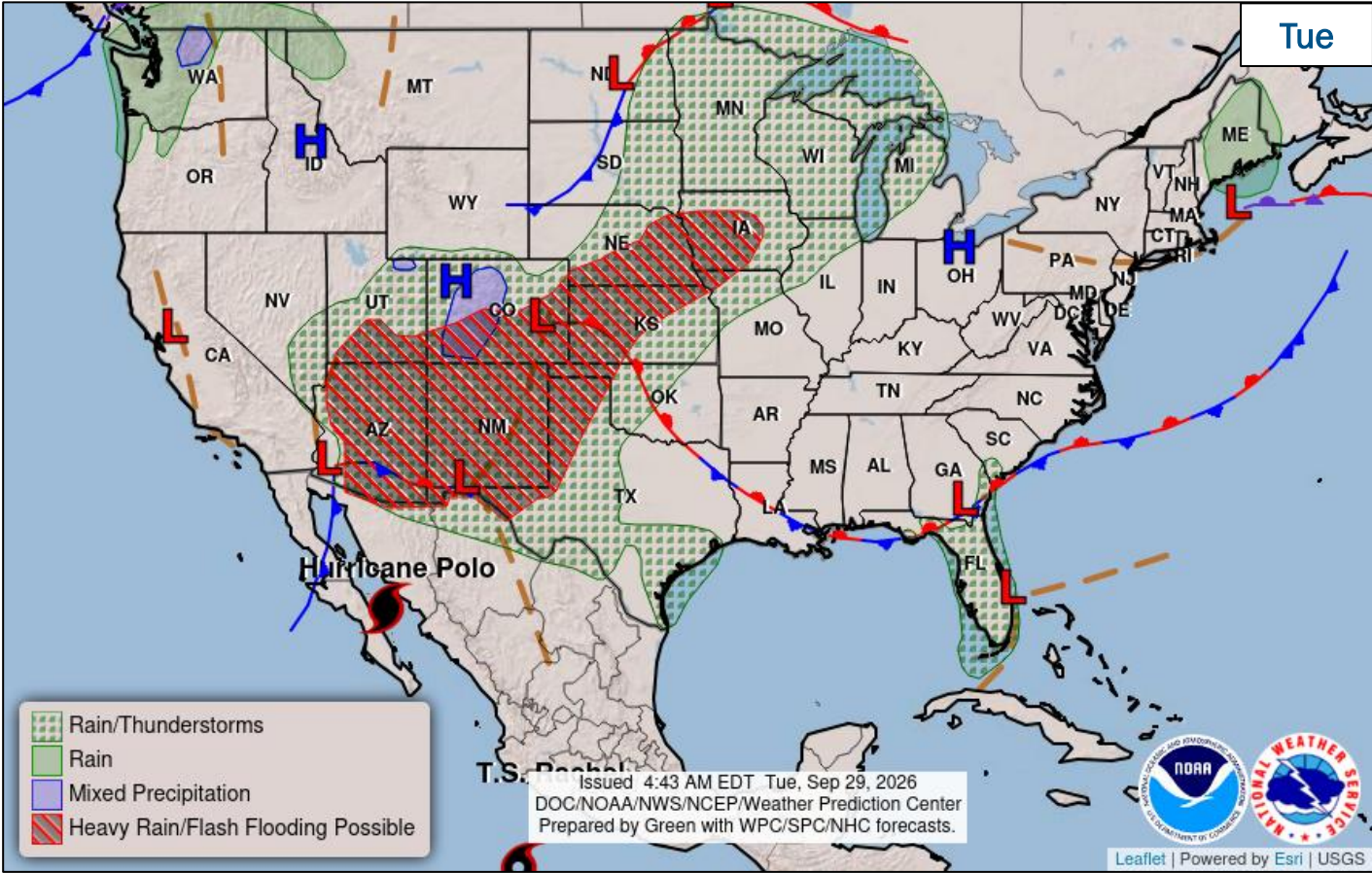
NWC will continue to monitor in coordination with FEMA Regions 6, 7, and 8. Reporting will continue in the National Situation Report (3:00 a.m. / 5:00 p.m. ET) and Daily Operations Briefing (8:30 a.m. ET).

National Watch Center



FEMA

National Weather Forecast



FEMA

INITIAL ATTACK ACTIVITY (24-hour period)	Light (89 fires)
New Large Fires	1
Large Fires Contained	0
Uncontained Large Fires	17
Year-to-Date Acres Burned	8,563,287
Total Responders	5,697
Type 1 IMTs Deployed	0
Complex IMTs Deployed	5
FMAGS	Total
2026 (FYTD)	63
2025	75
3 Year Average	53

Preparedness Levels:	
PL 1	Minimal fire activity; many resources available
PL 2	Large wildland fires burning throughout country; resources mobilized from other areas
PL 3	Wildfire activity ongoing throughout 25% of country; National Interagency Coordination Center (NICC) sets priorities, allocates resources, and mobilizes assets at national level
PL 4	High levels of fire activity and areas are competing for firefighting resources; 60% of the nation's wildland firefighting resources committed
PL 5	Extremely high levels of fire activity; 80% of nation's firefighting resources committed





FEMA Common Operating Picture

National Watch Center

Incident Workforce

18,807
Assigned a Disaster Title

5,494 / 29%
Deployed

6,638 / 35%
Available to Deploy for 30 Days

6,675 / 36%
Remaining

Surge Capacity Force
7,697 / 0 / 769
Rostered / Deployed /
Est. Available to Deploy for 30 Days

Tuesday
September 29, 2026
8:30 a.m. ET

National Readiness

National Watch Center

NRCC

N-IMAT Red

N-IMAT White

N-IMAT Blue

N-IMAT Gold

N-IMAT HS

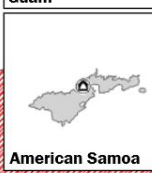
National Notes

National Watch Center:
• Staffing: Enhanced Watch (TC Nolo/SW Flooding)
(8:00 a.m. - 5:00 p.m. ET)

NRCC:
• Rostered

National IMATs:
• N-IMAT Red: Demobilizing
• N-IMAT White: Staffing
• N-IMAT Blue: Staffing

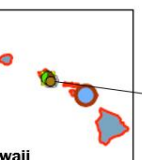
REGIONAL BREAKDOWN					
	JFO	DR	EM	JRO	
R1	0	1	0	0	
R2	0	0	0	2	
R3	0	2	0	0	
R4	3	10	0	1	
R5	0	3	0	0	
R6	4	7	3	3	
R7	0	9	0	0	
R8	0	9	0	0	
R9	0	6	7	0	
R10	4	7	2	0	



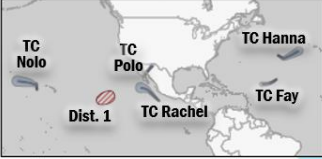
Camp Murray, WA
EM-3650-WA
• R10 IMAT

CNMI
DR-4910-MP &
EM-3647-MP
• R9 IMAT-2

Guam
DR-4921-GU &
EM-3648-GU
• ISB Delta

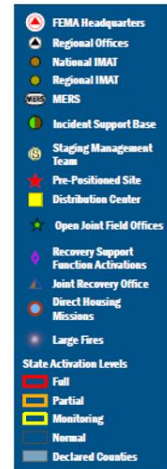
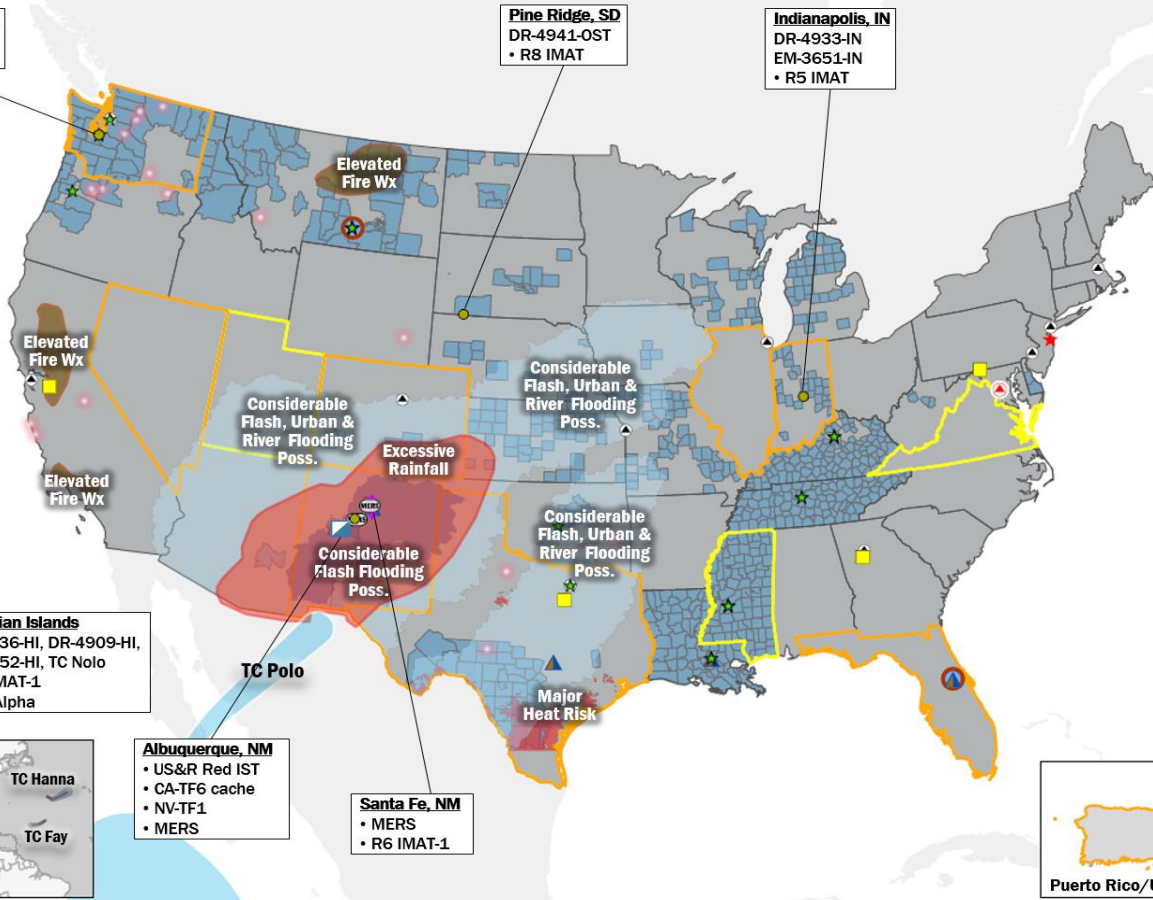


Hawaiian Islands
DR-4936-HI, DR-4909-HI,
EM-3652-HI, TC Nolo
• R9 IMAT-1
• ISB Alpha



Albuquerque, NM
• US&R Red IST
• CA-TF6 cache
• NV-TF1
• MERS

Santa Fe, NM
• MERS
• R6 IMAT-1



Regional Readiness

Watch RRCC IMAT

Region 1

Region 2

Region 3

Region 4

Region 5

Region 6

Region 7

Region 8

Region 9

Region 10

Regional Notes

Watches/RRCCs:
• R2 Watch: Equipment
• R5 Watch: Staffing
• R2 RRCC: Nor'easter
• R6 RRCC: Flooding
• R10 RRCC: Staffing

State EOCs:
• FL/MS: Previous Incidents
• CO/NV/UT/WA: Wildfires
• IL/TX: Severe Weather
• MP: TC Bavi/Saudel
• PR/VA: Drought
• IN: 4933-DR-IN/3651-EM-IN
• HI: TC Lowell/Tropical Activity
• NM: Excessive Rainfall

IMATs:
• R1/R4-1/2/R7: Staffing
• R5: 3651-EM-IN
• R6-1: Flooding
• R8: 4941-DR-OST
• R9-1: 3652-EM-HI/4909-DR-HI/4936-DR-HI/3654-EM-HI
• R9-2: 4910-DR-MP
• R10: 3650-EM-WA

Legend

- Fully Mission Capable
- Partially Mission Capable
- Requires Augmentation
- Deployed/Activated

Commodities & Equipment

	CONUS	Caribbean	Hawaii	Guam
Water				
Meals				
Generators				

SMT

Operational	11/11
Requires Augmentation	3/11
Deployed	0/11

MERS Det.

30/36 Operational	
Maynard	4/6
Frederick	6/6
Thomasville	6/6
Denton	6/6
Denver	4/6
Bothell	4/6

US&R

Task Forces	
Assigned	28
Non-FEMA Deployed	0
FEMA-Deployed	1
Not Mission Capable	0
Available	27
FEMA Support Staff	11/21

FCO

Assigned	38
Not Mission Capable	2
Deployed	33 (29 FCOR)
Available	3

Joint Preliminary Damage Assessments

Region	State / Location	Event	IA	Number of Counties		Start – End
			PA	Requested	Complete	
R5	MN	Severe Weather Sep 19-20	IA	4	0	10/1 – TBD
			PA	0	0	N/A
R10	AK	Mukluk Fire Aug 21-25	IA	1	0	9/21 – TBD
			PA	1	0	9/21 – TBD



FEMA

Declaration Request – Pueblo of Zuni

Declaration Type: Major Disaster – PZ

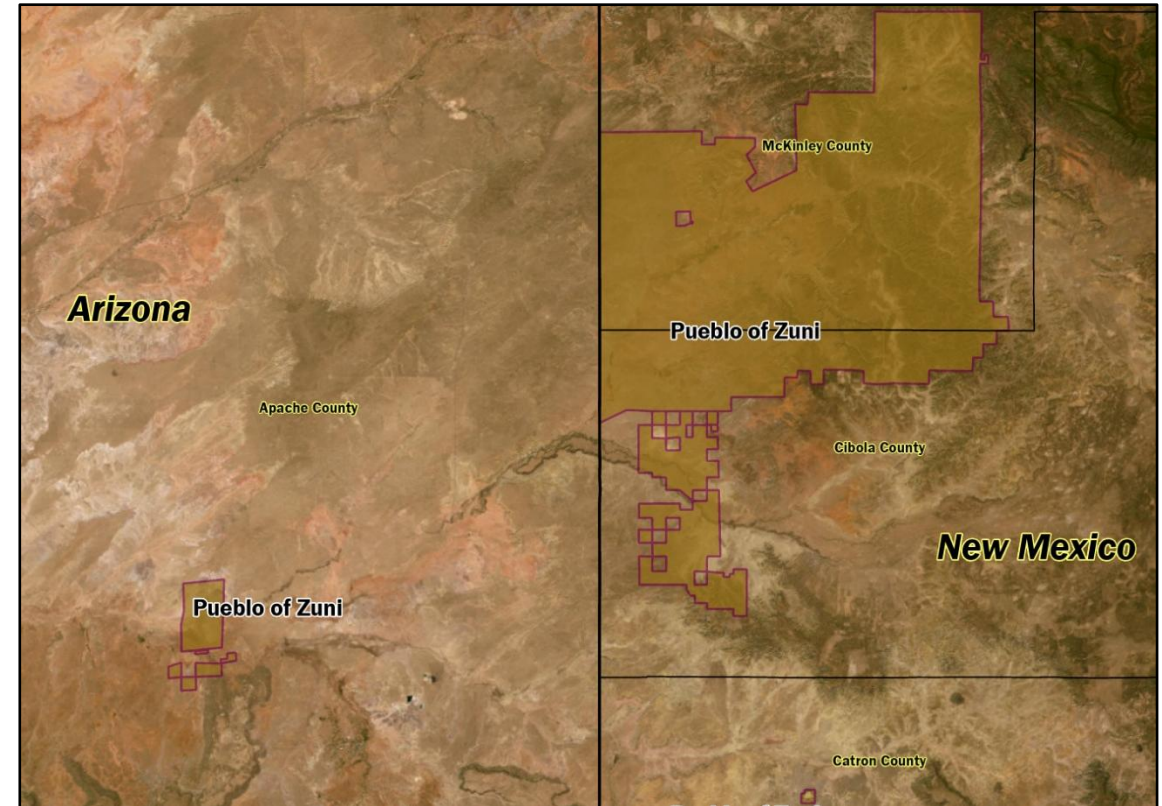
Date Requested: Sep 18

Incident: Severe Storms and Flooding

Incident Period: Jul 16-21

Requested:

- **IA/PA:** Pueblo of Zuni
- **Hazard Mitigation:** Pueblo of Zuni



■ IA/PA



FEMA

Declaration Requests in Process – 17

State / Tribe / Territory – Incident Description	Type	IA	PA	HM	Requested
NH – Severe Storm and Flash Flooding – Appeal	DR		X	X	Jul 8
IN – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, and Flooding	DR	X	X	X	Aug 6
GU – Super Typhoon Bavi	DR	X	X	X	Aug 11
MN – Severe Storms and Flooding	DR	X		X	Aug 20
UT – Cottonwood Fire, Flooding, and Mudslides	DR		X	X	Aug 22
WI – Severe Storms and Tornado	DR	X	X	X	Aug 26
WV – Severe Storm, Flooding, Landslides, and Mudslides – Appeal	DR	X		X	Aug 31
NE – Severe Storm, Straight-line Winds, and Flooding – Appeal	DR		X	X	Aug 31
OH – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, Flooding, and Landslides	DR	X		X	Sep 2
OK – Severe Storms and Straight-line Winds	DR		X	X	Sep 2
TN – Severe Storm and Straight-line Winds	DR	X	X	X	Sep 8
HI – Hurricane Lala	DR	X	X	X	Sep 8
HI – Hurricane Lowell	DR	X	X	X	Sep 9
WV – Severe Storms and Flooding	DR	X		X	Sep 12
IL – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, and Flooding	DR	X	X	X	Sep 15
KS – Severe Storm and Straight-line Winds	DR		X	X	Sep 15
PZ ¹ – Severe Storms and Flooding	DR	X	X	X	Sep 18

¹ Pueblo of Zuni



FEMA

National Watch Center



FEMA

Helping people before, during, and after disasters.



Scan to subscribe to this briefing.